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September 10, 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

I am very pleased to provide this reference for Younseo Song in recognition of the technical work he has performed for Hemmy Productions.

Younseo was asked to conduct a detailed technical and security assessment of the Hemmy Productions website, with the goals of understanding the site's underlying architecture, identifying technical and security vulnerabilities, improving performance, and helping prepare the website for future growth and potential investors.

He approached this work carefully and systematically, examining the website beyond its visible appearance and looking at its WordPress installation, page-building systems, plugins, themes, security configuration, administrator access, backups, updates, hosting environment, and overall site health.

One of the particularly useful things Younseo did was investigate what appeared to be inconsistencies between different areas of the website. Rather than simply assuming that the site contained multiple or fractured WordPress installations, he examined the architecture and determined that the differences were being created by the use of different editing systems — including the BoldGrid Post and Page Builder, Smart Slider 3 Pro, and the standard WordPress block editor. This gave us a much clearer understanding of how the website had actually been constructed.

Younseo also conducted a detailed review of the website's security and access controls. He verified that Wordfence brute-force protection was active and configured to automatically lock out IP addresses after 20 failed login attempts. He also reviewed administrator access and confirmed that access was restricted to only two active administrators, Younseo and myself. At the same time, he identified that Two-Factor Authentication had not yet been enabled and recommended that this additional security measure be implemented.

His examination of the website's backup systems was especially important. He identified that UpdraftPlus and Total Upkeep, including Total Upkeep Premium, were operating simultaneously. He explained that maintaining two backup systems could unnecessarily consume server storage and potentially contribute to performance problems during automated backup routines. He therefore recommended retaining UpdraftPlus as the primary backup solution and removing the redundant Total Upkeep systems.

Younseo also reviewed the site's SEO configuration and discovered that both All in One SEO (AIOSEO) and BoldGrid Easy SEO were active. He identified the possibility of conflicts between the two SEO systems and recommended consolidating the SEO configuration rather than maintaining unnecessary duplication.

As part of his technical review, Younseo examined inactive plugins and unused themes that were still stored on the server, including plugins such as Jetpack, Hello Dolly, MonsterInsights, and WP Super Cache. He identified these unused components as an unnecessary expansion of the site's security exposure and recommended removing them while retaining an appropriate default theme for fallback purposes.

He also investigated the site's health diagnostics and identified several critical technical issues. These included problems with automatic plugin and theme updates, which appeared to be associated with possible file-permission restrictions or delayed WordPress scheduled tasks. He explained the security implications of failed background updates and recommended verifying server write permissions and establishing a reliable process for monitoring updates.

Younseo further identified that the All in One SEO plugin was running an outdated version and recommended updating it promptly because outdated plugins can create security vulnerabilities.

Another important part of his assessment involved website performance. He identified slow server response times despite active page caching, explaining that this could negatively affect both the visitor experience and search-engine performance. He connected this issue to unnecessary server overhead and recommended reducing that overhead through cleanup and consolidation of the website's systems.

Younseo's recommendations extended to the hosting environment itself. He identified that the server was running PHP 8.2.30 and recommended upgrading to PHP 8.3 or later through the hosting control panel. He also identified delays in WP-Cron scheduled events and recommended addressing those delays so that background updates and other scheduled processes would execute properly.

He additionally recommended considering persistent object caching through Redis or Memcached to reduce database query loads and improve performance, as well as connecting the website to Google Search Console to improve search visibility and provide better marketing and search-performance analytics.

Perhaps most importantly for Hemmy Productions, Younseo understood that technical improvements needed to be made without damaging the creative work already present on the website. His recommendations specifically emphasized performing updates and technical changes carefully so that the existing homepage animation and other important visual features remained intact.

Overall, Younseo provided Hemmy Productions with much more than a general website check. He gave us a detailed technical picture of the website, identified security and performance risks, investigated the underlying architecture, evaluated our backup and SEO systems, reviewed our hosting and WordPress configuration, and developed a practical action plan for improving the site's reliability, security, and performance.

His work has been valuable because he combines technical investigation with practical problem-solving. He does not simply identify that something is wrong; he works to understand why it is happening and what steps should be taken to correct it while protecting the existing website and its functionality.

I am grateful for the time, technical knowledge, attention to detail, and care that Younseo has brought to Hemmy Productions. I would be pleased to recommend him to anyone seeking a technically capable, thoughtful, and responsible individual to assist with website technology, security, troubleshooting, and technical improvement.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Tessa Kendall McKenzie". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style with a large, elegant loop at the end of the last name.

Tessa Kendall McKenzie

Producer & Creator, For Love of the American Dream

Hemmy Productions